

Rep. Tom Emmer on the John Fredericks Radio Show

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****JOHN:**

** Okay, you got him, good to have you with us. I am your Godzilla of the truth in America, your Oracle of the deplorables. Coming live in Washington, D.C., Tom Emmer, greatest whip in the history of man. How this guy gets this stuff done, passes these bills with a two-seat majority and soon can't do anything is unbelievable. You know, when you think of the greatest house whips ever, they gotta make a statue of Tom Emmer, put it right outside the Capitol, right outside of his district there in Minnesota. Majority House Whip, Tom Emmer with us, Congressman of Minnesota, Tom, thanks for being with us today.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, thank you, John. About all I could think of, a statue, really? You know, the lefties will pull that one down right away. It's gonna be over. I appreciate all the compliments, but you and I have gotten to know each other a little bit. You know that I'm a team guy, right?

****JOHN:**

** Yes.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** We have the job of majority whip in the House, but we got a big team. We got the greatest deputy chief ever, Guy Reschenthaler from Pennsylvania. We've got a whole bunch of deputy whips that unlike maybe another body are totally on board with the Trump agenda that 77 million people voted for. And you keep asking, you know, how do we do this? We respect every single member. They've been elected, duly elected by at least 700,000 people or more, give or take, that those people, that's their voice. And we need to respect not just the member, but the people that voted for that member. And I think we've earned it over the last couple of years. People know that when we talk to them and we tell them where we're at, where the team's at, that we're telling them the truth. And whether it's good, it's bad, or indifferent, and the results show when you see the votes, John. And this week was amazing because we had three major whipped bills, which doesn't happen. I was told that they've never had three in the same week. And let's just say it was fun and it was wild. And at the moment of truth, it all came through. Just remember the whip team's job is to make the speaker and the leader look good and to make sure that we're honoring the promises that Donald Trump made to the American public, Donald Trump and our Republican majority. By the way, your previous guest, I'm gonna add one more thing. While I love his enthusiasm, a large majority is not 240. A large majority under the new maps for this decade is somewhere between 220 and 230. Donald Trump may have changed that, right? Because he brought over regular Democrat voters in the last election. Black voters, Asian voters, Hispanic voters, liberal Jews, young people, working men and women. He literally cracked the code on the Democrat voter that was left behind by their own party. They're not ours yet. They didn't sign up as Republicans, but because of Donald Trump, they're willing to look at our candidates, John, and they're willing to vote for him. So that 220 to 230 over this decade might actually start to grow.

****JOHN:**

** So to hold the house, you guys need what? 218, right?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah.

****JOHN:**

** 218 to hold the house. I'm probably one of the only guys in media that think you guys are gonna pull this out. I think you're gonna win Whitman in the first district in Virginia. I think you got the greatest candidate you could possibly have. I'm sorry, in the second district, Kagan's. I think she wins. I think Scott Perry, who'll be on with us Monday. I think he pulls it out. I think Bresnahan pulls it out. Fitzpatrick pulls it out. You win those seats, you guys are gonna win the house.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, and we are going to. I mean, not only are the people that you just named exceptional representatives and incredible campaigners. I mean, you wanna win campaigns. We got 435 pieces of geography in the house. Each one has unique demographics. You need the member or the candidate to look and sound, be from the district, right? And then they need to know the message that resonates and they need to be in touch with their people. So whatever the national pressure is, John, that comes down from above, our guys can fight their way through it. And you talked about Fitzpatrick, Jen Kagan's is amazing. Don't underestimate Rob Whitman. And last comment about your state of Virginia. I just wanna throw out, I'm gonna be surprised if they don't show their anger at being lied to in a governor's race last election. You know, you now have Tim Walz in a dress in the governor's office in Virginia. Abigail Spanberger lied to Virginians. She projected herself as a moderate left of center Democrat that would reach across the aisle and get things done for Virginians. And the second they put her in, she took her mask off and she became the wild eyed, crazy Marxist, communist leftist that some of us already knew she was. So I think that is going to help not only drive turnout, John, I think it's gonna help those people in their elections get reelected. I think Virginians have a tendency, it's a very educated state. I think they have a tendency to exercise their concerns at the ballot box.

****JOHN:**

** Majority House Whip Tom Emmer with us, Minnesota District Six Republican. Whip Emmer, I agree with you 100%. Spanberger's approval ratings in Virginia have tanked more in six months than anybody in history, in recorded history. It's now under the worst governors that we've ever had. I don't know how she gets out of it, but she's been a disaster. So I think that's gonna help Kagan's, it's gonna help Whitman. I think they win those seats and that's how you guys are gonna hold the House. Now, you got the reconciliation bill into, you got the SAVE Act and the reconciliation bill that's going to the Senate. Walk our audience through, Tom, how this gets to be law, what exactly has to happen in the Senate?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, the reconciliation bill came directly from the, I mean, Mike Johnson has talked about doing reconciliation 3.0. He's already talking about doing reconciliation 4.0. So people who are paying attention know that the House, and especially led by our speaker, is totally invested into using whatever tool is available to advance the America First agenda that Donald Trump has advocated for, and we promised to do. 3.0 ended up being very narrow, right? You've got 10 to 12 billion in there for ag. You've got money for the intelligence community because they're gonna need it. You've got defense money in it. People can be critical of that, but

they need to understand when it comes to those things, the reason it's so narrow, John, is that we started throwing in the other stuff. It would open up an amendment process in the Senate that literally they would offer hundreds of amendments to do what? To unwind all the reforms we got in the big, beautiful bill, the working families tax cut bill a year ago that Donald Trump signed into law. So it was a conscious decision that we have to keep it narrow so we can't allow the Elizabeth Warren et al., Chuck Schumer, all these crazy lefties, Bernie Sanders to come after the reforms that the American people are now enjoying. So it's narrow. The other thing that was an issue, and it was always going to be, it's not paid for. What does that mean? We sent over a little less than \$100 billion in this budget resolution. This is not the bill yet. People who are listening need to understand this is just the first step in the process. They pass it in the Senate. We both instruct the relevant committees as to what their limits are and what they can do, and then the committees will draft it. Once the Senate passes the budget resolution, if they do, then the House and the Senate will get to work, the relevant committees. We're trying to keep the Finance Committee out of it and others that could blow it up over in the Senate. They will get to work, and then you have a bill that actually has the language. But the pay-fors, it was an issue. This is what the White House asked for, again, because they didn't want to start pulling in these other jurisdictions, these other committees in the Senate, which could have been a disaster. And the real reason that it's built the way it is, John, is the Save America Act. I mean, this is one of the President's top priorities. And he is getting, well, getting, he, as you know, he has been very frustrated with the Senate that uses the filibuster, I would argue, and the parliamentarian. They hide behind that, both parties. This is why I've been saying regularly, there are no Republicans, there are no Democrats. They're just senators, right? They both play off this. It's the collegiality, it's the, oh, yeah, we're, they gotta understand, and I know that some of them are upset when I do this, because I get a little feedback from some of their more experienced members. But it's accurate. I am just as frustrated as the President. You have an 80% issue, John. This is not a Republican issue. This is an American issue. Republicans, Democrats, and independents in this country see no problem, and in fact, they want us to have citizens prove their citizenship when they register, and then prove that they are who they say they are, the citizen that they're supposed to be, with a photo ID when they show up to vote. That is an 80-20 issue. And I'm gonna say it again. I know I'm gonna get some feedback again. If you can't pass an 80% issue through this U.S. Senate, what the hell are you doing there, John?

****JOHN:**

** I think that's the question that everybody is asking, and you had John Thune yesterday come out and say, you know, I can count, I can't count to 50. Well, here's his problem. He's not gonna be able to count to 50 when he gets primaried in 2028 by Kristi Noem. Lewandowski's gonna run that campaign. He's not gonna get the 50% there either. The guy can't get this done. I just don't know, I don't know why the President doesn't just like say, look, let's give somebody else a shot, Mike Lee, Rick Scott, somebody, obviously you can't get the job done, and then get these people in and do something about it. Because, so walk us through, it goes into the Senate. You've got the SAVE Act in the reconciliation bill. What happens then?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, the White House is gonna go to work. That's why they wanted it. This is a, you know, it is not over. And I understand what John is saying. I feel for John because he's protecting his members. He sees this as his job is to protect the members who are stopping this from moving. Here's the thing, I'll give you the example in the House. I call them the old bulls. The men and women who have been here for a long time and saw this place operate differently. I mean, we have about, for the listeners, about a 50% turnover on the Republican side every, you know, two or three elections. But there are people who have the institutional knowledge and have been here. When our members started voting against rules, procedural rules, right? Because they didn't like the bill. And, you know, they were told the bulls would say, you don't vote against a rule. That is sacrilegious. You

don't do that. That's against what we stand for. My response was, I understand. But guess what? People are voting against rules now. So we can complain about it. We can say this is the way it's always been, or we can figure out how do we make sure that everybody feels part of the process so they'll vote for the procedural rule and they will vote for the bill. You don't sit back and go, well, the place doesn't change. I turn that now to the Senate. Don't tell us you don't have the votes. Figure out how to get the votes. And by the way, the reconciliation bill, once the parliamentarian goes through it, I don't even believe in the grant program, right? Because my state, Tim Walz is never gonna take a grant for the elections to make sure they're fair and honest. I believe it should be passed in full. The parliamentarian can certainly drop it out and say it doesn't fit in this, you know, the bird rule, quote unquote. Everybody blames the parliamentarian. But John, has anybody stopped to think about the fact that it only takes 50 senators plus one to overrule the parliamentarian? So it is actually a dishonest reflection of what's going on. The senators and especially the majority are in control of their own destiny. I got immense respect for all those guys despite my frustration, but I would ask every one of them that's like on the fence or is blocking this, why? Why would you block something that 80% of America agrees with? And by the way, I'm betting that the ones that are a no right now, they all supported it when they ran and since they've been here, what's the issue? I mean, is it Donald Trump? Are you just mad at Donald Trump? Please take your anger, take your frustration, put it to the side and work for the American people.

****JOHN:**

** It's Trump derangement syndrome is all it is. And the fact of the matter is they're not gonna overturn the parliamentarian because he can't get the 50 votes because then he would have to go on the record. And right now they can say things on whatever news channel they're on or whatever video they put out, but they're not on the record. Once you get this bill there, you gotta vote yes or no and they don't wanna do that. I mean, that's why this thing has never gone before the Senate. You've never had a vote on it because they don't wanna put themselves in a position to vote against 80-20. I mean, that's really what the problem is and they hate Trump. And so they see this as giving them a black eye. I want you to comment on what you saw in New Jersey on Monday after the president's speech, then you get Jersey, they say 6,600 people are on there. They're illegals, shouldn't have voted. They say, thousands of them voted. Then the Department of Justice says, no, it's not 6,600, it's 35,000. Turn over your voter rolls, they won't do it. What's the deal there, Tom Emmer?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, I'm living in Minnesota. And by the way, before we leave it, your statement about the Senate, they have to put up a vote. This is why I'm so grateful for my teammates, Mike Johnson and Steve Scalise. The only way you get anything done in Washington, DC is if you put people on the record. You bring the bill to the floor and you say, this is the moment of truth. You are going to show all of America and your constituents where you're at. And guess what? People tend to do the right thing when you do it that way. And they're just not doing it in the Senate. New Jersey, I think is a microcosm. It's amazing to me, the president of the United States goes on a national broadcast, NBC and these other folks won't carry it, right? And he talks about the serious international election interference here in the United States of America. He talks about the proof that they have uncovered since he came back into office. And it's like our left-wing media, John, just sits back and tries to pretend it doesn't exist. They write stories that, oh, these machines are, that they're so good, you can't do anything with them. Really? Whether it's 6,600 or 35,000, this is a problem, especially in blue states across this country. Minnesota is a classic example. You look at Minnesota, Pam Bondi, when she was the attorney general at the beginning of Donald Trump's second term, requested all the voter rolls and the voter history over the past several elections. That's the federal government asking for documentation so that they can verify the elections that Minnesota is responsible for. And the state is the one that administers elections at the local level, and they are responsible to administer the federal elections. Member of the U.S. House, members of the U.S.

Senate and the president, right? The federal government is entitled to see that they are doing that in an open, honest and fair manner. And you know what? I got a secretary of state that I knew when I was serving in the Minnesota legislature, Steve Simon. I don't know what has happened to Steve. Steve has become a hardcore Trump-hating partisan that said, no, no, I'm not gonna provide it. And my state frustrates me, John, because every Minnesotan, I'm sure the partisans on the left would disagree with me, but every reasonable Minnesotan, and there are a lot, they should be furious. If you don't have anything to hide, give them the voter rolls. They're clearly, New Jersey, I think, is just the tip of the iceberg. Minnesota has, you know, Donald Trump wins Tim Wall's hometown by 30 points, John. And you tell me he lost Minnesota by seven after he lost it by only two in 2016? Yeah, really? I wanna see your homework. I wanna be able to go through your homework. And clearly, they don't want anyone to look at their homework because I can only assume it's crooked.

****JOHN:**

** So the parliamentarian throws out the SAVE Act, which is what she's gonna do. She's gonna throw it out, doesn't matter if it makes sense or not. And then, soon does nothing, right? I mean, then there needs to be a vote on the parliamentarian. Then we even do that.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, John, but that's the issue. That's where we're gonna have a real problem. And I think all of our senators are going to run into a problem, even the ones that are great, because the frustration is going to continue to grow. They live in a bubble here in Washington, D.C. They have six-year terms, which means for four years at least, maybe five, they are stuck in an echo chamber, listening to each other, patting each other on the butt, wishing you have a great weekend, all this stuff. They're forgetting about the people at home that are so frustrated. And they listen to the media's garbage about, oh, this election's gonna be about the Iran war. It's gonna be about affordability. Well, that one's true, but it's not affordability. It's gonna be about the economy, right? And right now, the economy is, there are amazing things going on in the economy. Perception's not quite there yet. We've gotta have people, I should tell you this, John. I had a major bank CEO in here the other day. He was talking about that customer data that they have. And he said it's very clear in the past year that the people that are from the middle down when it comes to wealth or assets, so the lower end of the middle class, he said it's very clear that they are benefiting more than any other sector of America because of the big, beautiful bill and the tax cuts and the credits. He said, even though they tell you that they're struggling, you know, the news tells you people are struggling, John, their savings are going up. Their credit is not going up. Their credit is holding tight. They're not growing more credit. And by the way, he told me that their spending is up 6%. If that's the case across this country, John, the issue is, yeah, we got issues because of Iran, and the president is doing an amazing job, and I have confidence in him and Pete Hegseth and everybody that is executing. I don't have any confidence in our media in this country because they want to report that we are not succeeding on a regular basis. This is a problem that has come home very clearly, and we'll deal with that, I believe, after the Iran war, their mission is complete. Economy booming, all the underpinnings are there. Manufacturing is up, jobs are up, wages up. Even the stock market, I know that's up, but that's volatile. That doesn't affect everybody, but your salary, your wages, your jobs, your home, all of that is up.

****JOHN:**

** Okay, two things, Dan, hold the music a second. Two things. One, when are we going to get the AM radio and every car bill attached to one of these bills? When are we going to get this in? And can we do it before this session's over?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** So I have a group of our members, I don't know how big it's going to be, but it's going to be a significant number that are going to sit down with leadership and make it, obviously, I'll make it clear. I've been supportive of the AM radio bill from before it was offered, right? I actually, not as well as you do, but I did your job before I came to Congress. I was one of the talking heads on talk radio back in the Twin Cities. This is a national security issue. It really is. I mean, when you look at it, AM radio not only needs to be protected, it needs to be promoted. And especially for rural communities, outstate, non-urban, this is how they get their news. And when you have natural disasters, I got news for people who don't understand how radio works. AM radio many times is the only thing that is working after the tornado destroys a huge swath of the state or a flood is taking out, causing major damage. So this group, which includes two broadcasters, Mark Alford from Missouri and Jeff Crank from Colorado. You would love these two guys. Crank was a conservative radio talk show host in Colorado before he came to Congress. And Mark Alford was one of these TV pretty faces, which I'm saying that to you, I haven't said that to him. But Mark, I love what he says. He goes, you know, I came from one of the most least trusted professions to run for another untrusted profession. But these guys are committed to putting together a large group of our conference that already supports this and make sure that the leadership in the house understands this needs to be passed this year. Whether it's a standalone bill, whether you're gonna put it on something, the time has come. And I do believe it'll get done this year.

****JOHN:**

** Well, I tell you what, a lot of people are saying that. So I'm gaining more confidence. I know we're running very short on time. We both live in Washington, DC. I'm a ward two chairman, as you know, in my district here. One of the only elected Republicans in the district. We got a communist mayor coming in that all she wants to do is stop Trump. Like that's her whole agenda. I don't know how that helps your life in DC get better. Are you guys gonna look, if she comes in and starts unraveling what we've done here, which is make it the most cleanest, most safest, beautiful city. Are you guys gonna look at pulling home rule?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I would. I would have done that with Bowser or anybody else. I will tell you, the outgoing mayor, who has a lot of very strong rhetoric, which maybe you have to do that in the party of communism and Marxism and anarchism, but she clearly understands economics. She's making sure that whether it's the UFC fight over the 4th of July or the IndyCar race that is gonna take place here incredibly on the mall. She understands that brings people to the district of Columbia. And guess what? 200,000 people a day to watch the racing that's gonna be here. John, they gotta pay for lodging. They gotta pay for food and fun. And they're gonna do that. She's smart. I don't know about the incoming. I've seen all the rhetoric and all the awful things. Maybe the incoming mayor's gonna have some understanding, but regardless, you don't even have to put that in the mix for me. I don't think they should have a mayor and a city council. I think the Congress should go back to running the district of Columbia.

****JOHN:**

** All right, I'm gonna go with, so James Comer, your colleague, just jettisoned out their tax increases. I mean, you can't make this stuff up. So congratulations, but I'm gonna call Sally and get to your office. I know you gotta go. Let's end on a high note. Twins won two in a row. They got a two game winning streak, right? Three games back in the wild card, only four and a half out of the division. Everybody knows the White Sox are gonna fold. It's just a matter of time. They're really not that good, either is Cleveland. I think you guys got a shot to win the division. I think you gotta get a shot to win, to get in the wild card. And you know, you had a little bump there, but you just won two games. Twinkies are right there.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I love this part of the discussion. Your Astros and my twins climbing up the ladder after they were down in a bit of a hole. The twins were not as far as Houston, but Houston has done a good job climbing back. Baseball this year is amazing. There's so much parody. And I love what you're saying. And I do, I'm so happy for the Minnesota twins. They are punching above their weight. The pitching, you know, the coaching deserves huge credit. But I gotta tell you, the team that concerns me are the Detroit Tigers. The Detroit Tigers should have started out much better. If you look at what they've done over the last month and a half, look out. The Tigers are common.

****JOHN:**

** Yeah, and the Tigers are tested compared to those other teams. You're right about Cleveland. Cleveland is just a hat with nothing under it. And, you know, the White Sox, I think, are a team of the future. I could be wrong. Maybe they'll gel right through the end and then make a run in the playoffs. I don't think they're there yet, though. I'm very impressed by how they're rebuilding. But the Central, you know, everybody's like 500 or under 500. In the division that you've got with Houston, you know, whether it's the Mariners, whether it's, it's like nobody wants to win it. It's like they get a little roll and then they take a couple weeks off.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, we're five games under 500 and two games out of first place. I mean, don't think of that. But I agree with you. It sounds like the U.S. Senate.

****JOHN:**

** Exactly, exactly. It's like the Indians, the Guardians, whatever they are, Cleveland. No, no, Ramirez, all had no cattle. I think I still predict that Twins are going to win that division, but I'd be worried about Detroit also, especially because Scoble now is pitching for generational bajillions of dollars because he's actually staying with Detroit. Every game he pitches now is worth probably another \$10 million in his new contract, assuming there's baseball in 27, which I don't think. I don't know that's going to happen. I think you got to get a salary cap. Tom, I'm going to get with Sally, get to your office. Thanks for your time today. Thanks for being with us.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Thank you, John. Thanks for what you do. We love you. I'm unable to add speaker labels to this transcript segment because ****the segment appears to be empty**** — no actual transcript text was included in your message. Could you please paste the transcript text you'd like me to label? Once you share the content, I'll apply the ****JOHN:**** and ****REP. TOM EMMER:**** labels accordingly.

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